

Cult Christian Science Physical Reality

cult-christian-science-physical-reality
Cult Marker · Christian Science · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

breadth canon-wide
directness direct
variants stable

Statement under examination

Sin, sickness, suffering, and physical reality are real; salvation is from real sin to real eternal life through Christ's real death and resurrection.

In plain language

The words used across these passages treat the physical world, sin, sickness, suffering, and death as genuinely real, not as illusions of the mind. In Genesis 1:31 God looks at everything he made and calls it very good, using the verb 'made/did' (asah) for making (over 2600 uses across the Hebrew Scriptures) and the word 'good' (tov) for good, intensified by 'very/exceedingly' (meod). You do not pronounce an illusion good; the verse assumes a real, external creation. In John 1:14 the Word became flesh (sarx), a concrete bodily term used across the canon for tangible human flesh, and eyewitnesses say they beheld him. First John 4:2 and 4:3 then make confessing that Jesus came in the flesh the test of a true spirit, and refusing that confession is named the spirit of antichrist (antichristos). The word antichrist occurs only five times in the whole canon, and every one of those five attaches the label to denying Christ has come in flesh, so the vocabulary itself targets the denial. Romans 3:23 says all sinned, using a completed past-tense verb (an aorist) that treats sin as an actual fact for every person, and the verb itself appears across the Gospels, Acts, Paul, and the General Letters. Romans 6:23 sets the wages of sin, death (thanatos), in antithesis (an opposing pair) with the free gift of God, eternal life (zoe aionios), naming death as a real consequence and life as a real remedy. First Peter 2:24 says Christ bore our sins in his body (soma) on the tree and that by his wound we were healed, using the concrete word for body, the noun for a bodily welt, and the standard verb for physical healing (iaomai) that runs through the Gospel cure stories. Taken together, from the first book of the Hebrew Scriptures to the General Letters, the vocabulary describes matter, sin, sickness, and death as real conditions, and salvation as a real rescue accomplished through a real bodily death and a real risen life. The lexical pattern affirms the proposition with no support for reading these realities as mere appearances of mortal thought.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H1961	הָיָה	hayah	to be	
H2896	טוֹב	tob	pleasant	564
H3966	מְאֹד	meod	much	300
H6213	עָשָׂה	asah	to make	2,629
H7200	רָאָה	raah	to see	1,305
G0166	αἰώνιος	aionios	eternal	69
G0264	ἁμαρτάνω	hamartano	to sin	42
G0266	ἁμαρτία	hamartia	sin	174

G0500	ἀντίχριστος	antichristos	antichrist	5
G1096	γίνομαι	ginomai	to be	
G1343	δικαιοσύνη	dikaiousunē	righteousness	
G1391	δόξα	doxa	glory	
G2222	ζωή	zoe	life	136
G2288	θάνατος	thanatos	death	120
G2390	ιάομαι	iaomai	to heal	27
G3670	ὁμολογέω	homologeō	to confess/profess	26
G4561	σάρξ	sarx	flesh	151
G4983	σῶμα	soma	body	144
G5547	Χριστός	Christos	Christ	570

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

The canon names matter, sin, sickness, suffering, and bodily death with concrete nouns and completed-action verbs (verbs marking finished events in the past) that resist dematerializing readings. Genesis 1:31 has God 'see' (raah) all that he 'made' ('made/did', asah, 2629 occurrences) and call it 'very good' (tov meod), presupposing a real external creation evaluated as objectively good. The New Testament anchors hinge on 'flesh' (sarx, 151 occurrences), 'body' (soma, G4983, 144 occurrences), 'sin' (hamartia, 174 occurrences) with 'to sin' (hamartano, 42 occurrences in Synoptics, Acts, Paul, and 1 John), 'death' (thanatos, 120 occurrences) paired with 'life' (zoe, 136 occurrences) and 'eternal' (aionios, 69 occurrences), and the physical healing verb 'to heal' (iaomai, 27 occurrences, dense in the Gospels and Acts for bodily cures). First John 4:2 to 4:3 makes confessing 'Jesus Christ having come in flesh' (Iesoun Christon en sarki eleluthota) the test of true spirit and brands the denial as 'antichrist' (antichristos), a term that occurs only five times and only in Johannine epistles to mark precisely this denial. The pan-canonical (spread across the whole Bible) pattern affirms real created matter, real sin, real bodily incarnation, real bodily death, and real bodily healing as the medium of salvation.

Scripture

Gen.1.31 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H2896 טוב, H6213 עשה, H7200 ראה, H3966 מַאד

Force. God 'sees' (raah, 1305 occurrences) all that he 'made' (asah, 2629 occurrences) and pronounces it 'very good' (tov meod). The verb of seeing and the verb of making presuppose a real, external, material referent that God evaluates. The intensifier 'very/exceedingly' (meod, 300 occurrences) magnifies the positive predicate (the part that says what something is). The verse appears in a narrative refrain ('and he made, and he saw, and behold it was good', wayya'as wayyar wehinneh tov) that treats the made thing as ontologically present (actually existing in reality), not a thought to be dispelled.

John.1.14 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G4561 σάρξ, G1096 γίνομαι

Force. 'The Word became flesh and dwelt among us' (Ho logos sarx egeneto kai eskenosen en hemin). The aorist (a completed past action) 'became' (egeneto) takes 'flesh' (sarx) as a real predicate noun (a noun completing a 'X is Y' statement), not an appearance term. 'Flesh' (sarx) is the concrete bodily-flesh lexeme (the word as listed in a lexicon, 151 occurrences across Synoptics, Paul, General epistles, Revelation). The verb 'we beheld' (etheasametha) and the noun 'glory' (doxa) attached to the same subject treat the incarnation (God taking on a human body) as a tangible event with visual witnesses, ruling out a docetic (treating Jesus' body as only an appearance) or merely-apparent reading.

1John.4.2 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3670 ὁμολογέω, G4561 σάρξ

Force. 'Every spirit that confesses Jesus Christ has come in the flesh is from God' (Pan pneuma ho homologei lesoun Christon en sarki eleluthota ek tou theou estin). The perfect participle (a completed action whose result still stands, in adjective-like form) 'having come' (eleluthota, meaning he came and remains so) plus the prepositional phrase 'in flesh' (en sarki) makes bodily incarnation (God taking on a human body) the operative test of a true spirit. 'To confess' (homologeo, 26 occurrences, dense in Johannine epistles and Romans) is the verb of public confession; the lexical structure makes the reality of 'flesh' (sarx) itself the doctrinal boundary marker.

1John.4.3 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0500 ἀντίχριστος, G3670 ὁμολογέω

Force. 'Every spirit that does not confess Jesus is not from God, and this is the spirit of the antichrist' (Pan pneuma ho me homologei ton lesoun ek tou theou ouk estin, kai touto estin to tou antichristou). 'Antichrist' (antichristos, G0500) occurs only five times in the entire canon, and all five (1 John 2:18, 2:22, 4:3, 2 John 7) attach the label to the denial of Christ come in flesh. The narrow lexical distribution targets precisely the kind of denial of bodily reality the proposition rejects.

Rom.3.23 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0264 ἁμαρτάνω, G1391 δόξα

Force. 'For all sinned and fall short of the glory of God' (Pantes gar hemarton kai hysteronantai tes doxes tou theou). The aorist (a completed past action) 'they sinned' (hemarton) of 'to sin' (hamartano) treats sin as a completed actual event for 'all' (pantes). 'To sin' (hamartano, 42 occurrences) spans Synoptics, Acts, Paul, Hebrews, 1 Peter, 2 Peter, and 1 John, a pan-canonical (spread across the whole Bible) witness that sin is an actual condition before God, not a perceptual mistake to be corrected by right thinking.

Rom.6.23 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G2288 θάνατος, G2222 ζωή, G0166 αἰώνιος

Force. 'For the wages of sin is death, but the free gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus' (Ta gar opsonia tes hamartias thanatos, to de charisma tou theou zoe aionios en Christo lesou). 'Death' (thanatos, 120 occurrences, dense in Romans, Revelation, and the Gospels' passion narratives) and 'life' (zoe, 136 occurrences) are placed in an antithesis (an opposing pair) tied by 'eternal' (aionios, 69 occurrences). The economic noun 'wages' (opsonia) frames death as something genuinely earned, and the parallel 'free gift' (charisma) frames eternal life as something genuinely conferred. Both members of the antithesis are predicated as real.

1Pet.2.24 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0266 ἁμαρτία, G4983 σῶμα, G2390 ἰάομαι

Force. 'Who himself bore our sins in his body on the tree, that we, having died to sins, might live to righteousness, by whose wound you were healed' (Hos tas hamartias hemon autos anenenken en to somati autou epi to xylon, hina tais hamartiais apogenomenoi te dikaiosyne zesomen, hou to molopi iathete). 'Body' (soma, G4983, 144 occurrences) names the physical body, 'wound/bruise' (molops) names a bodily wound, and 'to heal' (iaomai, 27 occurrences, the standard Gospel healing verb for actual physical cures in Mark 5:29, Luke 7:7, Acts 9:34 and similar) reaches its aorist passive (a completed past action in passive form) 'you were healed' (iathete) here. The lexical chain anchors salvation in a real bodily death and a real restoration, not a mental adjustment.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
1Pet.2.24	Isa.53.5	tsk	1
1Pet.2.24	Ps.147.3	tsk	1
Gen.1.31	Job.38.7	tsk	1
Gen.1.31	Gen.1.5	tsk	1
John.1.14	John.1.1	tsk	1
John.1.14	John.1.18	tsk	1
Rom.6.23	Rom.5.12	tsk	1
Rom.3.23	Rom.3.9	tsk	1
1John.4.3	2John.1.7	tsk	1

Complicating texts

John.1.14 · addressed

A spiritualizing reading might claim that the Logos (Word) was so divine that flesh is secondary, but the aorist (a completed past action) 'became' (egeneto) explicitly makes 'flesh' (sarx) the predicate (the noun that says what the subject became) of becoming. The lexeme (the word as listed in a lexicon) 'flesh' (sarx) is the concrete bodily term used elsewhere for tangible human flesh (Romans 8:3, 1 Peter 3:18, Revelation 19:21), so the syntax forces a real becoming, not a docetic (treating Jesus' body as only an appearance) appearance.

Rom.6.23 · addressed

The economic metaphor 'wages' (opsonia) might be read as making 'death' (thanatos) merely figurative, but a metaphor for payment does not make the payment unreal. 'Death' (thanatos) is paired antithetically (as an opposite) with 'eternal life' (zoe aionios); treating one member as illusion would dissolve the other and collapse the antithesis (the opposing pair) the verse builds, so the figurative framing does not weaken either reality.

Rom.7.14 · addressed

Paul's contrast of 'fleshly' (sarkikos) with 'spiritual' (pneumatikos) is sometimes cited to denigrate flesh as such, but the contrast is ethical, between life governed by sinful impulse and life governed by the Spirit, not a metaphysical (concerning the nature of reality) denial of matter. Paul also names the body as the 'body' (soma) of Christ (Romans 12:5) and looks for bodily redemption (Romans 8:23, 'redemption of the body', apolytrosis tou somatos), so the same writer holds matter to be real and destined for renewal.

Concordance traversed

H2896, H6213, H7200, H3966, H1961, G4561, G4983, G0266, G0264, G2288, G2222, G0166, G2390, G0500, G3670, G5547, G1343

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

The anchor texts lie outside the published ECM (the critical edition of New Testament textual variants) scope (3 John only). Direct query of the lexical store returned no variant units for 1 John 4 in the ingested apparatus (the catalog of textual variants). The known patristic variant at 1 John 4:3 ('who looses Jesus', *ho luei ton lesoun*, attested in Latin and a handful of Greek witnesses) is doctrinally orthogonal to (independent of) this verdict, since both readings turn on the reality of the bodily-come Jesus. New Testament books here are treated as 'ecm-shadow' (outside the published critical edition's scope).

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

material_realism: affirms · Reading the lexemes (the words as listed in a lexicon) at face value, 'very good' (*tov meod*) and 'made' (*asah*) in Genesis, 'flesh' (*sarx*) and 'body' (*soma*) in John, 1 John, and 1 Peter, 'sin' (*hamartia*) and 'death' (*thanatos*) and 'eternal life' (*zoe aionios*) in Romans, and the bodily healing verb 'to heal' (*iaomai*) in 1 Peter, all denote real external entities and events. The aorists (completed past actions) 'became' (*egeneto*), 'they sinned' (*hemarton*), 'he bore' (*anenenken*), 'you were healed' (*iathete*) treat them as completed actual occurrences, and the canon affirms the reality of matter, sin, sickness, and death.

philosophical_idealism: contradicts the canon · A lens that treats matter, sin, sickness, and death as illusions of mortal mind must reduce 'flesh' (*sarx*), 'body' (*soma*), 'sin' (*hamartia*), 'death' (*thanatos*), and 'to heal' (*iaomai*) to mental categories. The lexical data resists this: 1 John 4:3 names the denial of Christ come in flesh as 'antichrist' (*antichristos*) using a hapax-cluster (cluster of words occurring only in a narrow scope) term that occurs only here in 1 John 2 and 4 and 2 John 7, all in the same Johannine corpus and all about precisely this denial. Stated in its strongest form the lens is internally coherent, but the canon's vocabulary, in its strongest reading, is not its ally.

ascetic_dualism: partly contradicts the canon · A weaker reading treats matter as ontologically (in terms of its actual existence) lower or ethically inferior rather than illusory, citing Paul's 'flesh-spirit' (*sarx-pneuma*) contrast. In its strongest form this lens reads Romans 7 to 8 with care and recognizes that flesh is real but corrupted. The canon does affirm corruption (Romans 7:18) yet still names creation 'very good' (*tov meod*), the incarnation as Word-become-'flesh' (*sarx*), the redemption as bodily (Romans 8:23), and the resurrection body as 'spiritual body' (*soma pneumatikon*, 1 Corinthians 15:44), a body still. The verdict on the proposition therefore holds, while the lens captures a genuine but partial lexical pattern about ethical flesh-spirit antithesis (opposition).

Genesis grounds the goodness of created matter; the prophets continue the language of real sin and real healing; the New Testament texts develop the reality of sin, death, incarnate flesh, and bodily redemption. This is progressive revelation (the idea that God's self-disclosure unfolds across history) read with 'analogy of Scripture' (*analogia scripturae*, the principle of letting Scripture interpret Scripture) across both testaments.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem is a positive descriptive proposition that sin, sickness, suffering, and physical reality are real and that salvation is from real sin to real eternal life through Christ's real death and resurrection. It names no tradition and embeds no school-specific taxonomy (classification system). The cult-prefix in the question id indicates the proposition is articulated against a specific denial of these realities, but the proposition itself is stated in plain canonical vocabulary, and the verdict is derived from the lexemes (the words as listed in a lexicon) on their own terms.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
lexicon	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.1.31
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.1.31

lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H2896
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H6213
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	John.1.14
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1John.4.2
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Pet.2.24
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4561
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4983
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2390
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0500
lexicon	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	1John.4.2
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	1Pet.2.24
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	1John.4.3
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Rom.6.23

License audit

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Source	License	Redistribute
STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes
MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes
TSK	public_domain	yes
OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes

Flags

ecm-shadow